"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 5

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

- The historical figures mentioned in chapter 5 lived between the creation of the world and the global flood (see Genesis 6-9). This period of history is sometimes called the antediluvian age. The flood occurred approximately 1650 years after the earth was created.

Characters:

- **Adam and Eve** – The first man and woman.
- **Methuselah** – The longest recorded human life, he died at 969 years old.
- **Noah** – The main character of Genesis 6-10. At God's instructions, his family built an ark to survive a worldwide flood.

Where:

- Genesis 5 is a genealogy that records the names of Adam and Eve's descendants through their son, Seth. The author doesn't give us specifics about where these men and their families lived.

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Outline:

- PURPOSE OF GENESIS 5:
    + Chapter 5 is a genealogy.
    + A genealogy is "an account of the descent of a person, family, or group from an ancestor" (Webster).
    + This particular genealogy tracks the descendants of Adam and Eve, not through Cain (their oldest son) but through Seth.
- THE GENEOLOGY OF ADAM AND EVE THROUGH SETH (5:1-32):
    + Adam fathered Seth when he was 130 years old and died at the age of 930.
    + Seth fathered Enosh when he was 105 years old and died at the age of 912.
    + Enosh fathered Kenan when he was 90 years old and died at the age of 905.
    + Kenan fathered Mahalalel when he was 70 years old and died at the age of 910.
    + Mahalalel fathered Jared when he was 65 years old and died at the age of 895.
    + Jared fathered Enoch when he was 162 years old and died at the age of 962.
    + Enoch fathered Methuselah when he was 65 years old. Enoch didn't die a natural death. We are told the Lord "took him" at the age of 365.
    + Methuselah fathered Lamech at 187 years old and died at the age of 969.
    + Lamech fathered Noah at 182 years old and died at the age of 777.
    + Noah fathered Shem, Ham, and Japheth at 500 years old.

Application:

- You may read this list of names and think it holds no value for modern readers, but there is a reason the Bible records information like this.
- Throughout the Bible God made several important promises pertaining to specific families and their future children (their descendants).
- Having a record of the ancient family lines allows us to see how God kept His promises across the generations.
- These genealogies are records of fathers and sons, but more than that they are records of God's faithfulness.
- They are evidence to us that God is trustworthy and never breaks His promises.